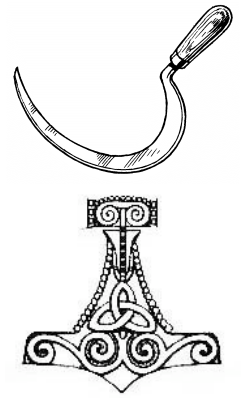


DER WONNENACHTSEGE

02. WONNET, 2015



ZUFIEGE ZUM JOE MAREK UN ZUM BRIAN WEIS
REV - 0 - 2012

Honoring: Holle, Vorgenger (those who have gone before)

Die Aarufing

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune is intoned thrice: Hagalaz, Kenaz, Jera, Wunjo

Die Heiliching

*Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet
un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu beile
un zu sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
Bei de Fraae Berchta un Holle fer es Volk
zu erneire
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell!*

*Sickle, make holy this altar and this site.
Protect us with the craft of the Deities
By Wudan and Frigg to build the community
By Ziu and Zisa to keep justice and frith

By Frey and Freya to cut and to gather
the bounty
By Thor and Sif to empower the people
By the Ladies Berchta and Holle to renew
the people
As the Hammer forges the Sickle
So the Sickle feeds the Hammer
It is the Cycle of life, to sow and to reap
Sickle, make holy this altar and this site.*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Hail!

Hail!

Hail!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer unser Haerrinn Holle zu ehre.

Unseri Haerrin Holle iss die mild, doch mechdich, Beschitzerin vum Pennsilfaanisch Deitsch Volk. Mit der Weisheet, der Gnaad, un em Mitleid fiehrt die Holle uns darrich de Leweszeitte.

Heit sehne mir, as es Land bei ihrem Gefiehl erneirt iss.

Es Lewe schpringt ums ringsrum!

Losset uns zamme die Leweswonne feiere!

We are gathered here to honor our Lady Holle.

Holle is the mild, yet powerful, Protectoress of the Deitsch nation. With Wisdom, Grace, and Compassion, Holle guides us through the lifetimes.

Today we see that the Land is renewed by Her touch.

Life is springing all around us!

Let us celebrate the joy of life together!

Heel Holle!

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Liewi Haerrin Holle!

Mir bidde Dich mit uns zu bsuche

Un mit uns heit die Wonne zu feiere

Sei unser verehrter Gaschtin

un unseri Freindschaft verdeele.

Heele!

Dear Lady Holle

We bid Thee to visit with us

And to celebrate the joyous time with us today

Be our honored Guest

And share in our community.

Hail!

Es Opfer un Die Eed - Offerings and Oaths

Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle

Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.

If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.

If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - Hallowing of the Offerings

Zu Dir, Liewi Haerrin Holle

Mir hewwe die Seidel aa

To Thee, Dear Lady Holle

We lift the Stein

*Mir biede Met un Seider aa
 Un gewwe die do annere Gschenker
 Wie 'n Zeichnis zu unserer Dankbaarkeet
 un vun unserer Gemeeschaft
 Darrich Dich binne mir uns fescht aa
 Losst 's immer so sei!*

*Heel Holle!
 Heel zu de Ziewe!
 Heel zu de Vorgenger!
 Heel zu de Noochkummer!
 Heel die Gemeeschaft!*

*We offer mead and cider
 And give these other gifts
 As a symbol of our gratitude
 And of our community
 Through Thee we bind ourselves fast
 May it always be so!*

*Hail Holle!
 Hail to the deities!
 Hail to the ancestors!
 Hail to the descendants!
 Hail to the community!*

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Sing Heel Dir Holle

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
 Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder*

*From the gods to the Earth to us
 From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
 Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.
 Hail!*

Zum Schluss - In Closing

*Heit beginne mir en neis Wonefescht
 un baue do en schtandhafliches Bindnis zamme
 Mit de Ziewe
 Un darrich unserer allgemee Zweck
 Losst uns zamme immer schtarricker waxe.
 Der Sege iss beschlosse waerre.*

*Today we begin a new festival of joy
 and build here a steadfast alliance together
 with the Deities
 And through our common purpose
 Let us all grow stronger together.
 This Sege is closed.*

Zu de Wichde - To The Wights

*Mir gewwe aa en Opfer zu de Wichde
 Vun desem Land
 Un mir bedanke uns 'ne
 Fer ihrer Schirm*

*We give also an offering to the Wights
 of this Land
 And we are thankful to them
 For their protection*

Heel!

Hail!

Die Aarufing

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun der Nadde, vun der Erd, vun em Schtee

Mit der Ruhzeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit Erdgraft sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Naddwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun em Oscht, vun der Luft, un em Sunnuff

Mit Yungezeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit Luftgraft sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Oschtwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun der Sudde, vun em Summer, un em Feier

mit Leidenschaft im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmliche mit Feier sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Suddwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun em Wescht, vun em Wasser, un Schpotyaahr

Mit Heemgehzeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit em Wasser sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Weschtwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu de mitleidiche Graft vun em Himmel, vun em Schepfer, vun em Schtanne

Mit der Umwandleheet im Hatz

Kumm doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit em Himmel sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Himmelwind in uns!

Ich ruf die mitleidiche Graft hie vun unich der Erd, der Geischthieling

Mit Freindschaft im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit de Voreldere sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich es Gebliet in uns!

The Invocation

I call upon the compassionate powers of the north, of the earth, of the stone with the time of rest in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of earth.

The dear gods and goddesses through the northwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the east of the air, of the sunrise with the time of youth in heart.

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of air.

The dear gods and goddesses through the eastwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the south, of the summer, and the fire, with passion in Heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of fire.

The dear gods and goddesses through the southwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the west, of the water, and autumn, with the return to home in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of water.

The dear gods and goddesses through the westwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the heavens, of the creator, of the stars, transformation in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of the heavens.

The dear gods and goddesses through the heavenwind in us.

I call the compassionate powers here from under the earth, the spiritcave (dwelling of the ancestral spirits), with our
lineage (vorbearers, ancestors) in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the ancestors.

The dear gods and goddesses through the blood (family) in us.

Hail!

Discussion Topics

- This is one of the highest holidays on the Urglaawe calendar. It is frequently known as Walpurgisnacht, but, since Walburga was a Christian missionary, the terms Wonnennacht or Hexennacht are more appropriate.
- Significance comes to us through Heathen, through Braucherei lore, and other Deutsch folklore.
- The night of April 30 into May 1 is observance of the return of Holle from the Furious Host (Wild Hunt) that began on Allelieweziel (31. Gehling/October) to the soil. Her return brings the land to back to full life. Note that Urglaawe "days" begin the night before, so the night of April 30 is actually May 1. Thus, Wonnennacht is May Day. There is a distinct relationship between the return of Holle and the May Day celebrations of fertility.
- Holle is likely a member of the Wane (Vanir) tribe of the deities. *Teutonic Mythology* indicates Her consort as Holler, who may be Ewicher Yeeger seen in Deutsch lore.
- Holle is a well-known and proactive deity within Urglaawe and Braucherei. She plays an active role in the birth-life-death-rebirth cycle, including protecting the souls of the deceased until they are ready for the next life. She is associated with anything cyclical or spiral.
- Time-cord work in Braucherei and mythic imagery carry knowledge of Holle putting souls through Her Mill to prepare for the rebirth of the parts of the soul that are reborn. The soul is seen to have twelve parts, at least one of which is reborn into a subsequent generations. Some say that this is why people feel sometimes like a new acquaintance is so familiar.
- In some parts of Europe, this is a night to dress in costume and burn effigies of witches (a Christian image). We, of course, view this differently and it is not a matter of evil but of spirituality. Many events related to the Furious Host involve costumes (Halloween, King Frost, Belsnickel, Mummers, Mardis Gras, and perhaps even the roots of the April Fool. Did you ever notice how all these costume events disappear after the end of April? They all represent the parade of spirits that is now over. Walpurgisnacht itself is a Christian term, so we are gradually encouraging utilizing "Wonnennacht" ("Joy Night") instead.
- In Deutsch lore, on April 30 and May 1, people open all their doors and their windows to the home and hang a sign over the doorway. The sign reads, "WALBURGA" or "HOLLE" and welcomes Holle into the home.
- The fairy tale of *Frau Holle* indicates that She likes an orderly, clean home. The concept of "spring cleaning," at least among the Deutsch, has its origins in the time of preparation for Her arrival. Spring cleaning is initiated at Grundsaudaag with the cleaning of the hearth and is to be concluded by Walpurgisnacht. Brauchers move items out of halls and remove clutter from the path at this time (alas, I am remiss in this effort, though I keep trying!).
- It is safe to put frost-hardy plants into the ground, but Deutsch lore says that frost-sensitive plants should wait until the daytime of May 15. Three Frost Giants pass through on May 13, 14, and 15 (See "Twelve Nights of the Wonnendanz" below).
- The lore gives these frost giants' names as Dreizehdax ("thirteen badger", Vatzehvedder ("fourteen quill" (porcupine)), and Fuffzehfux ("fifteen fox"). These same Giants appear as scouts for King Frost in November.

Seasonal Focus

Walpurgisnacht to Midsummer: Experience the joy of life, including the joy of planting new life in the ground. Make the planting a spiritual, loving event. Revel in friends, family, kindred, hobbies, and things you enjoy. Moifescht (May Day) is also the observance of male creative energies.

Keep in mind that days in Urglaawe practice begin at sundown. Thus, sundown on Thursday, April 30 (Dunnerschdaag, 30. Oschdret), is actually the beginning of Friday, May 1 (Freidaag, 1. Wonnet).

Lunar Lore

This year the first new moon after the Spring Equinox came quite late, so we were in the trickster "Elbedritsch" (Snipe) or "Haas" (Rabbit) moon until April 18. The Holzhaahne (Woodcock) moon started on April 18. Those born under the Holzhaahne moon are said to reflect some of the characteristics of the woodcock. On the positive side: able to survive with marginal resources, able to sense rising opportunities, willing to work to earn its own keep, very loyal to close friends. On the somewhat negative side: opportunistic, flashy, vain.

Mitleid - This is the virtue of Compassion. The concept is different from the modern era understanding of this word, however. The focus of Mitleid is that of an appropriate compassion for others who are in a position through no fault of their own or who have seen their errors and are attempting to correct them. Compassion for irresponsibility is detrimental to the whole of the community. However, equally detrimental is providing no path to redemption for those who are trying to straighten themselves out. They become stuck in a quagmire of their mistakes, even if they are striving to distance themselves from their prior behavior.

In some cases, the compassion is towards those who have experienced a loss or a tragedy. This may include a loss of employment or losses incurred in a natural disaster, etc. Each year, Urglaawe organizations hold a food drive at Erntfescht. Filling the local food banks can help the wider community. These are gifts in exchange for the gifts we have in our lives. They are voluntary and free of compulsion. Also, we never know whether we may be in need of such assistance ourselves someday.

We should take careful consideration of the errors or crimes and the efforts the individual is taking to correct his/her ways. Mitleid can result in our lending a hand, when feasible in order to help strengthen our community overall.

The folk tale of *Frau Holle* provides some insight into the Germanic understanding of the importance of Mitleid. The mistreated stepdaughter falls into a well and awakens in Holle's meadow. The girl encounters some bread that is baking in an oven and will soon burn if not removed. The girl dutifully removes the bread.

She then encounters an apple tree, the branches of which are heavy with apples. The girl shakes the tree to lighten its load. Holle rewards these compassionate acts, along with other virtuous behavior, by covering the girl in gold before sending her back to her family. Conversely, her lazy stepsister, who lacks virtue consistently throughout the tale, is covered in pitch

Verwandschaft: The virtue of Kinship reflects the need that all of us have to belong to a community. Despite the efforts of the consumer culture to separate and divide people in order to increase corporate bottom lines, it is unnatural for humans not to live and to exist in a social setting. Kinship, along with other virtues, can help to create an environment of security, trust, and interdependence among the members of a community. Even while we embrace Self-Reliance (*Selbschtzuverdraue*), we also embrace that community interdependence, which is reflected in the Heathen concepts of gift exchanges and frith.

Twelve Nights of the Wonnedanz

Every now and again, I come across short references that help to fill in some gaps in the understanding of our traditional practices.

One such gap is the time between Walpurgisnacht and the arrival of the Reifries (Frost Giants) thirteen days later. I think we finally have an answer.

On our current calendar, Walpurgisnacht falls on the night of April 30. However, since Urglaawe days begin at sundown, that night is actually 1. Wonnet (May 1) on the Urglaawe calendar. Deutsch tradition is that the Witches' Dances (Hexedanz) or the Dance of Joy (Urglaawe: "die Wonnedanz," which translates to the "the dances of joy") take place at a variety of locations across the Deitscherei. Primary among these sites is Hexenkopf, which is located in Williams Township in Northampton County, but there are other sites as well.

In Germany, similar traditions relate to the Brocken, also known as Blocksberg, in the Harz Mountains. While I cannot speak to the exact meaning of the traditions at the Brocken, the impetus for the celebration in Deutsch culture is the return of Holle to the Hatzholz (also known as Mannheim, Midgard, or the physical realm). Hexenkopf is said to be Her home in this land. Her return brings order to the land and begins the growing season.

Tradition also holds that the Frost Giants become aware of Holle's return and attempt to destroy the order by freezing the land. Different Braucherei guilds have variations of this story, but the most cohesive version states that the first Frost Giant, Dreizehdax, arrives on the night of May 12 into May 13, which is actually 13. Wonnet on the Urglaawe calendar. Dreizehdax's efforts are thwarted by Dunner, and the Frost Giant is forced to retreat.

On the next night (May 13 into May 14), another Frost Giant, Vatzehvedder, makes his attempt. On that night, Dunner provides instruction to all of the Butzemenner (activated scarecrows) across the countryside in how to stop the Frost Giant. Vatzehvedder is also forced to retreat. On the third night (May 14 into May 15), Fuffzehfux makes his attempt and is beaten back by the combined efforts of the Butzemenner. After the pass of Fuffzehfux, it is considered safe to plant all crops outdoors.

I have often wondered about a few things regarding the variations of this story. For starters, there are so many locations where Witches' Dances (Hexedanz) and Wonnedanz were said to take place. Also, I wondered about the gap between the celebration of 1. Wonnet and the battle with Dreizehdax on 13. Wonnet.

Both situations can be explained by a small reference on p. 1619 of Volume IV of Grimm's *Teutonic Mythology*: "The Witches' Excursion takes place on the first night in May"... "They ride up Blocksberg on the first of May, and in 12 days must dance the snow away; then Spring begins."

This implies that the Wonnedanz is a multiple night occasion, perhaps symbolically beginning in the lowlands and working its way up the hills into the mountains. In our case, it would begin in places like Hexefeld near Riemescheddel in the lowlands, up through Hexebaerrick in Berks County, and ending at Hexenkopf.

For Reference

The Heathen Nine Noble Virtues (Die Nein Edelreenheide):

der Mut: Courage

die Waahrheit: Truth

Honor: die Ehr

Fidelity/Troth: die Treie

Discipline: die Addning

Hospitality: die Uffwaarting

Self-Reliance: es Selbschtzuverdraue

Industriousness: die Schaffichheit

Perseverance/Steadfastness: die Ausdauer

Implied among these, but more directly state in Urglaawe, are ancillary virtues called Newwereenheide:

Wisdom: die Weisheit

Introspection: der Selbschtreiguck

Kinship: die Verwandschaft

Generosity: der Edelmut

Curiosity: die Neigierheit

Compassion: es Mitleid

Self-Improvement: die Selbschtverbessering

Stewardship: die Verwalting

Spirituality: die Geischtlichkeet

Es Hollelied

**Heel Dir, Holle, ed'li Mudder
Heel Dir Holle, hohi Fraa
Seele sinne dief im Wasser
Seele sinne dief im See
Fedderflocke falle sietsam
Fedderflocke falle g'lind
Geb uns gudi Arewet heit un
Geb uns gudi Arewet nau
Glitzerend scheine die do Flocke,
Glitzerend scheint der Schnee im Land.
Baad mich mol yetz in Deim Brunn do
Der Brunn bringt mich in Dei Land.**

ROUGH ENGLISH TRANSLATION

**Hail Thee, Holle, noble mother,
Hail Thee, Holle, high woman.
Souls are sensing deep in the water,
Souls are sensing deep in the sea.
Feather flakes are falling softly,
Feather flakes are falling mildly.
Give us good work today,
Give us good work now.
Glittering shine these flakes,
Glittering shines the snow on the land.
Bathe me in your well, well brings me to your land.**

ORIGINAL GERMAN

Heil Dir, Holle, lehre Mutter,

Heil Dir, Holle, hohe Frau.

Seelen sinnen tief im Wasser,

Seelen sinnen tief im See.

Federflocken fallen leise,

Federflocken fallen lind.

Gib uns gute Arbeit heute,

Gib uns gute Arbeit nun.

Schillernd scheinen deine Flocken,

Schillernd scheint der Schnee im Land.

Bade mich in Deinem Brunnen,

Brunnen bringt mich in Dein Land.

Original German by Birgit Knorr

First public performance: Urglaawe rite to Holle, Trothmoot, 2013